BOSS Today

Staff Guide

How to write, edit, publish and design the paper in the BOSS Today newsroom.

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> **The one rule to remember.** Nothing reaches the website until someone with the Issue permission publishes an issue. Saving, approving and designing all prepare the next issue; they never change the live site on their own. The few exceptions (live updates, the banner, Publish now, emergency withdrawal) are marked in this guide.

1. Getting started

The newsroom is where staff work. Readers never see it.

Signing in

- Go to the newsroom address your editor gave you and add **/admin**, or use **Staff sign-in** at the bottom of the website.
- Sign in with Google (school account) or the email and password you were given. Change a temporary password the first time.
- Forgot your password? Ask an exec with the Staff permission to reset it.

Roles

Role	Can do
Reporter	Write and edit their own stories, upload pictures, send stories for review, comment.
Editor	Everything a reporter can, plus edit anyone's story, approve or send back, add corrections, run the assignment board.
Exec	Everything an editor can, plus whichever permissions below they have been given.

Permissions (given by the super admin)

Permission	Allows
Issue	Publish issues, rebuild the site, post live coverage, publish design changes straight away.
Design	The site designer, sections, site settings and the classic front page. Editors can have it too.
Print	Print editions: choose stories, layout and paper size.
Staff	Create accounts, reset passwords, set positions, deactivate people who leave.
Media	Manage the picture library, including deleting pictures.

Your profile

Open your name at the top right. Add a photo and a short bio: they appear on your author page and the Our Staff page. Untick **Show me on the Our Staff page** to stay off the public list.

2. How a story gets published

1. **Draft.** A reporter writes and saves. Only staff can see it.
2. **In review.** The reporter clicks **Submit for review**. Editors are told.
3. **Sent back** (if needed). The editor clicks **Send back to reporter** with a note. The reporter fixes it and submits again.
4. **Approved.** The editor clicks **Approve for the next issue**. The text is now locked for reporters.
5. **Published.** The issue publisher reads every approved story, ticks each one, and publishes the issue. The website rebuilds within a few minutes.

Changing a story that is already live works the same way: save the change, then an editor clicks **Approve changes for the next issue**. Readers keep seeing the old version until the next issue.

The assignment board

Assignment board in the sidebar shows every story idea in four columns: **Unclaimed**, **Writing**, **In review** and **Waiting for the issue**. Filter by section or reporter to see who is doing what before deadline.

3. Reporters

Starting a story

- Click **+ New story** in the sidebar. Pick a story template if one fits (event, game recap, profile…): it fills in a structure with **TK** notes to replace.
- Fill in the **headline**, a one- or two-sentence **summary**, the **section**, **authors** and the **story**.
- Save often. Saving never publishes anything.

Writing notes and style suggestions

The panel on the right counts words and reading time and lists anything missing (summary, section, author, photo credit, picture descriptions, TK notes). Under **Style suggestions** it points out common newsroom-style problems:

- Exclamation marks, capitals or a full stop in the headline
- No one quoted or named as a source
- Unnamed sources (they need an editor's approval)
- Paragraphs over 80 words, sentences over 40
- Dates: **Oct. 16**, not October 16th
- Times: **7 p.m.**, not 7:00 PM
- Percentages: **per cent** in stories
- Exclamation marks, filler words, double spaces

These are suggestions. They never stop you saving or submitting.

Pictures

- **Lead image:** the photo at the top of the story and on the front page.
- Every picture needs a **description** (alt text, for readers who can't see it), a **caption** (who, what, where) and a **credit** (the photographer).
- Only use photos you or the paper took, or that you have permission to use.

Photo galleries and video

- In the story editor, type **/** or use the **+** menu and choose **Photo gallery**. Add 2 to 20 photos and an optional title. Readers swipe through them; the print edition shows the first four.
- Choose **YouTube video** and paste a YouTube link to embed a video. On paper it becomes a link.

Comments from editors

Editors can highlight text and leave comments. Reply or fix the text, then the editor resolves the comment. A story can't be approved while comments are open.

> When it's ready, click **Submit for review**. If the button is greyed out, save first.

4. Editors

Reviewing a story

1. Open stories **In review** from the dashboard or the assignment board.
2. Read it in full. Check names, titles, dates, numbers and quotes; check that every claim has a source; check the headline is fair.
3. Fix small things yourself. For bigger problems, comment on the text or use **Send back to reporter** with a clear note.
4. When it's right, **Approve for the next issue**.

Corrections

When a published story has a mistake, add a row under **Corrections** with the date and what was wrong, fix the text, and approve the change. Published corrections can't be edited or removed: add a new one instead. Follow the corrections policy on the Our standards page.

Reader submissions

Reader submissions holds letters, tips and correction requests from the contact form. Readers give a real name and a verified email. Turn a letter into a draft for the Letters section, a tip into an assignment, or open the story a correction request is about.

Our standards

The website's **/standards/** page sets out how the paper works: independence, accuracy, corrections, sources and anonymity, fairness, privacy, conflicts of interest, photos and AI. Editors are expected to know it and apply it.

5. Publishing an issue

For people with the Issue permission.

1. Go to **Issues** and create one (title, volume, number, date). Tick **Print edition** if there will be a paper copy.
2. Open it and choose **Review & publish this issue**.
3. Read every story in full with **Read the full story**, then tick it. Each tick is recorded with your name and the time. If a story isn't right, send it back: it won't go out.
4. Check **Other changes going live**: sections, tags, custom pages, site settings, the site design and the banner. If it warns that a design changed on desktop since anyone checked the phone layout, open the designer and look at the phone view first.
5. Tick the publisher's declaration and click **Publish issue and rebuild the website**.

The site rebuilds in a few minutes and the progress is shown. If publishing fails, the message names the story or setting that caused it and nothing is published.

Rebuilds

The site can be rebuilt **400 times a month**. The counter is at the top of the checklist. **Rebuild site now** on the dashboard rebuilds without publishing anything new, for example after a failed build.

Taking a story down

To remove a published story with the next issue or rebuild (out of date, a duplicate, replaced by a newer story), an editor opens it and chooses **Take down with the next issue…** with a reason. It stays on the website until the next issue or rebuild; the checklist lists it under **Coming down**, and publishing takes it off. **Keep it on the site** cancels.

To take down a whole issue's stories at once, open the issue and use **Take down all its stories…** in the sidebar (Issue permission), or **Keep them all on the site** to cancel. Stories marked to come down are taken off when the next issue is published **or** when someone uses **Rebuild site now**, which says how many first.

Emergency withdrawal

> If a published story must come down at once (a serious error, a legal or safety problem), an editor opens it and chooses **Emergency withdrawal…** with a reason. The site rebuilds without it straight away. Tell the editor-in-chief.

6. Live updates

These go to the website within a minute, without waiting for an issue.

Where	Who	What it does
Scores & schedule	Reporters and up	Games, results and live scores on the front page and /scores/.
Calendar	Editors and up	School events on the front page and /calendar/.
Live coverage	Issue permission	A page of timed updates for big events (elections, games, emergencies). While it is **live**, a LIVE link appears on the front page.
Banner	Issue permission to publish	A short notice across the top of every page (snow day, deadline). Normally it goes live with the next issue; it can be published now, and given an end time.

Every live change is recorded in the activity log with who made it. Live coverage skips the usual sign-off, so check each update before posting.

7. Print editions

For people with the Print permission.

1. Open the issue and tick **Print edition**. Use **Add all waiting stories**, then reorder them.
2. For each story choose its width (full, two thirds, half or one column) and whether to show its picture.
3. Choose the paper size, whether to include a contents box and the staff box, and an optional announcement. **QR codes** under each story (on by default) take paper readers to the story online, with every photo and video.
4. After the issue is published, the PDF is made with the website and linked from the issue page.

Check every page of the PDF before printing: headlines breaking badly, pictures cropped, empty space. The staff box lists people by position, most senior first.

8. The site designer

For people with the Design permission. Like Canva, for the website.

What you can design

The menu at the top left of **Site designer** picks what you are editing:

- **Header** and **Footer**: on every page. The header must keep its navigation bar, and the header or footer must keep Staff sign-in. You can restyle and move them, not remove them.
- **Front page** and **custom pages** (About us, Join us…): free canvases. **+ New page…** makes one at /p/its-name/; **Page settings** sets its title, address and whether it appears in the navigation or footer.
- **Page templates** for story, section, topic, author, issue and other pages: canvases **above**, **beside** and **below** content that is laid out automatically, plus the content's width, position and fonts, and which parts of a story show.

Adding things

- **Text**: heading, subheading, body text
- **Shapes**, lines and arrows
- **Image**: crop, shape (circle, star…), filters, shadow, border, set as background
- **Icon**: search 5,000+ free icons
- **Table**: paste from a spreadsheet
- **Story**: a chosen story, or "newest in a section", which updates itself
- **List**: Latest, Most read, a section
- **Box**: Scores, This week, LIVE link, Latest issue
- **Site part**: navigation, search, date, site name, footer links…

Working on the canvas

- Drag to move, corners to resize, the round handle to rotate (`Shift` for 15° steps). Double-click text to edit it.
- Things snap to each other and to the page. Turn on **Rulers** and drag from them to add guide lines; drag a guide back onto the ruler to remove it.
- **Copy style** and **Paste style** carry a look from one item to others of the same kind.
- **History** goes back to any earlier step. **Templates** starts from Classic, Big photo, Breaking news or Feature, or a template your newsroom saved.

Phones

Phones get their own layout, made automatically. Switch to **Phone** to check it and move things by hand, then mark it checked. Readability is checked as you go: text that is hard to read can't be saved, and the designer suggests a better colour.

Saving and going live

Changes save automatically as a draft and go live with the next issue. Someone with the Issue permission can use **Publish now** for something that can't wait (it uses one rebuild). One person edits at a time;

others can watch or take over.

9. Site settings

For people with the Design permission. Changes go live with the next issue.

- **Site name, tagline, footer note, social links.**
- **Look:** link colour, text colour, background, and the fonts for headlines and stories, labels, and the masthead. Hard-to-read colours are refused with a suggestion. Dark mode keeps a dark background automatically.
- **Editorial standards:** the /standards/ page. It starts with a suggested draft; edit it to match how your newsroom really works.
- **About page** and **Join us** text.
- **Google Search Console code:** lets the editor-in-chief see how the paper does in Google. Stories carry the information Google News needs, and the site lists new stories for it automatically.

Sections and topics (tags) are managed under **Site** in the sidebar.

10. People

For people with the Staff permission and the super admin.

- **New member:** `People` → create, with their name, school email, a temporary password and role (usually Reporter).
- **Positions:** choose their jobs (Editor-in-Chief, Sports Editor, Staff Writer…). The form shows the access those positions usually need; only the super admin changes role and permissions. With no title written, positions become the title under their byline.
- **Our Staff page** and the print staff box are grouped by position: masthead, section editors, copy and standards, visuals, print, digital, operations, reporters and writers.
- **Someone leaves:** untick **Active**. They can no longer sign in, and their bylines stay. People who signed off an issue can't be deleted, because that record is kept.

11. Social media

Instagram images

Open any story and find **Instagram images** in the sidebar:

- **Post ↓** downloads a 1080 × 1350 image for the feed.
- **Story ↓** downloads a 1080 × 1920 image for Stories, with space at the bottom for a link sticker.

Both use the story's current headline, section and lead image under the masthead. Add the link in your bio or a link sticker, and write a caption that adds something rather than repeating the headline.

Link previews

When anyone shares a story link (Instagram, iMessage, WhatsApp, email), the preview shows a picture made for that story with its photo, section and headline. Other pages show the masthead. These are made when the site is built.

Following the paper

The **/subscribe/** page explains feed readers and lists the feed addresses for the whole paper and each section.

12. Quick reference

Designer shortcuts

Keys	Does	Keys	Does
`Ctrl` + `Z`	Undo	`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z`	Redo
`Ctrl` + `C` / `V`	Copy / paste	`Ctrl` + `D`	Duplicate
`Ctrl` + `Alt` + `C` / `V`	Copy / paste style	`Ctrl` + `G`	Group (`Shift` to ungroup)
`Ctrl` + `]` / `[`	Forward / backward	`Ctrl` + `A`	Select all
`T` `R` `O` `L`	Add text, rectangle, circle, line	Arrow keys	Nudge (`Shift` for 10)
`Delete`	Delete	`Esc`	Deselect / finish editing

Limits

- 400 site rebuilds a month (each issue, withdrawal, Publish now and Rebuild site uses one).
- Pictures up to about 4 MB each; they are converted and resized automatically.
- Galleries: 2 to 20 photos. Tables: up to 30 rows.

When something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
"Nothing was published"	Read the rest of the message: it names the story or setting. Fix it and publish again.
A button is greyed out	Save first, or you don't have the role or permission. Ask an exec.
"Someone is editing the design"	Wait, or choose Take over if they've left.
The website didn't change	Changes wait for the next issue. Live updates take about a minute; refresh.
A rebuild failed	Use Rebuild site now on the dashboard. If it fails again, tell the Web & Tech Lead.